

Παρθένιος ὁ Νικαεύς

Parthenius of Nicaea and the Love Stories

eul_aid: oec

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή λογοτεχνική [Literary Koine](#)
Domain: Μυθιστορία [Fiction](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Parthenius of Nicaea, known as the Elegist, was a Greek poet and grammarian of the 1st century BCE. Born in Nicaea in Bithynia, he was taken to Italy as a prisoner during the Mithridatic Wars. Freed in Rome, he became a teacher of Greek, instructing the poet Gaius Cornelius Gallus, to whom he later dedicated his **Erotika Pathemata**. He was also associated with Virgil and served as a key conduit of Hellenistic literary culture to Roman poets.

His only substantially surviving work is the **Erotika Pathemata**, a prose collection of 36 love-story summaries compiled for Gallus. Other attested but lost poetic works include **Metamorphoses**, **Delphica**, **Arete**, **Iphiclus**, and an **Encomium of Arete**.

Parthenius is significant as a direct cultural intermediary. His **Erotika Pathemata** provided Roman poets with mythological source material, influencing the neoteric and Augustan literary movements. Through his teaching and writings, he helped shape the development of Latin love elegy and other poetic genres.

Works (3)

- Ἀποσπάσματα καὶ Τίτλοι · [Fragments and Titles](#) · 8 passages
- Ἑρωτικά Παθήματα · [Love Stories](#) · 139 passages
- Λείψανα Ποιήσεως · [Remains of Poetry](#) · 45 passages